

# KELLY THAO

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LinkedIn: [www.linkedin.com/in/kellyjthao](https://www.linkedin.com/in/kellyjthao) | GitHub: <https://github.com/kjthao> | Portfolio: <https://kjthao.github.io/portfolio/>

## SKILLS

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**Programming/Scripting Languages:** HTML, CSS (Proficient) | C#, R (Familiar)

**Tools & Software:** Git, GitHub, Unity, Adobe Premiere Pro

**Soft Skills:** Project Management, Team Collaboration, Communication, Problem-Solving

## EDUCATION

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**University Of South Carolina, Columbia, SC**

Aug 2022 – Present

*Bachelor of Science in Computer Information Systems, Business Information Systems and Media Arts minors*

**York Technical College, Rock Hill, SC**

Aug 2020 – May 2022

*Associate in Arts*

## PROJECTS

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**Capstone Project (CSCE 490-492)**

Spring 2025

*Dare Divers:*

- Built a 2D multiplayer survival game in C# using Unity as part of a team-based project. Led project management using GitHub for version control, milestone tracking and collaboration.
- Designed core gameplay mechanics, enemy AI, UI/UX, and delivered a POC demo and RC1 build, and conducted QA testing for a peer team's release candidate.

**Web Applications (CSCE 242)**

Spring 2025

*Full-Stack Web Application:*

- Built a responsive, full-stack web app using HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React, and Node.js.
- Integrated MongoDB for data storage and used Git/GitHub for version control.

**Video Game Design (MART 581D)**

Fall 2024

*Flightless:*

- Designed a solo narrative-driven 2.5D platformer, applying iterative design principles throughout.
- Authored a 20-page Game Design Document covering mechanics, narrative, and technical specifications.
- Developed a core mechanic demo to validate gameplay concepts.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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**Kohl's, Rock Hill, SC**

Jun 2025 – Present

*Sales and Customer Service Associate:*

- Supported customers with in-store and digital services including Amazon returns, Kohl's app navigation, and online order placement.
- Operated POS systems and Zebra devices; fulfilled Omni orders (BOPUS), processed price changes and ticketing, and served as Sephora backup when needed.
- Trained new associates on register and sales floor operations, handled customer service phone calls, and managed 100+ merchandise go-backs across multiple departments.

## LEADERSHIP & ACTIVITIES

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**University Of South Carolina, Columbia, SC**

Aug 2025 – Present

*Alliance for Women in STEM:*

- Member of a collaborative organization supporting underrepresented groups in STEM through workshops, research opportunities, and discussions on challenges face by women in the field.

**Molinaroli College of Engineering & Computing, Columbia, SC**

Sep 2025 – Dec 2025

*MCEC Peer Mentorship Program, Mentor:*

- Mentored a first-year student in navigating academic resources, campus opportunities, and college life, sharing strategies for coursework and professional development to build skills and confidence.

**York Comprehensive Highschool, York, SC**

Aug 2018 – May 2019

*Drum Major:*

- Led rehearsals, maintained tempo during practices and competitions, and trained new members for a 150+ member band.